

Facilitating complex operations, ClickID allows software to identify add-on board peripheral configurations seamlessly. A demo library is available, demonstrating the reading, writing, and processing of data from the ClickID. The full application code and ready-to-use projects are easily accessible through NECTO Studio Package Manager, LibStock, or MIKROE's GitHub account.

For Linux-based systems like BeaglePlay, ClickID simplifies the addition and operation of peripheral add-on boards. Leveraging the 1-Wire protocol, it communicates with the operating system kernel, enabling automatic recognition of silicon ICs on add-on boards. This results in the delivery of manifest files to the operating system, streamlining the loading of appropriate drivers for interfaces such as SPI, I2C, UART, PWM, and ADC.

Christine Long, CEO of BeagleBoard.org Foundation, commented, "This is a big step enabling users of boards like our BeagleBoard.org BeaglePlay to simply use the well-tested code that is already there without needing to search and integrate; just connect and play!"

Silo AI launches Poro, the open source LLM for EU languages

Silo AI, the Helsinki-based AI startup, has unveiled Poro, an open source large language model (LLM) designed to enhance multilingual AI capabilities for all 24 official European Union languages. Poro is the inaugural model in a series, developed by SiloGen and the University of Turku's TurkuNLP research group.

"It is a digital sovereignty question where you want to ensure that there are models that are capturing the value base, the culture, the languages," said Peter Sarlin, CEO of Silo AI. "Ultimately, it's about value creation, ensuring that not



only European but any company out there can create value that stays within Europe and stays within that organisation."

Named after the Finnish word

for 'reindeer', Poro features a 34.2 billion parameter model utilising a BLOOM transformer architecture with ALiBi embeddings. Training on a 21 trillion token multilingual data set, including English, Finnish, Python, and Java, it addresses the challenge of creating effective natural language models for lower-resourced European languages.

Poro is trained on LUMI, Europe's fastest supercomputer in Kajaani, Finland, equipped with 512 AMD Instinct MI250X GPUs. The Poro Research Checkpoints program ensures transparency in documenting the model's training progress. Sarlin noted, "There aren't initiatives that have given such transparency to model training."

Teaming up with the University of Turku, Poro represents collaboration between applied AI expertise and academic leadership in multilingual language modelling research. "If Poro delivers on its promise, it could democratise access to performant multilingual models, giving Europe a homegrown alternative to systems from US tech companies," Sarlin noted.

Microsoft and Google collaborate on OneTable

Microsoft and Google have teamed up with Onehouse to back the OneTable project, reshaping the cloud data lake scene. This collaboration tackles the challenges organisations face in choosing data lake table formats, aiming to prevent vendor lock-in and compatibility hurdles for data analytics and AI workloads.

OneTable, initiated by Onehouse and announced in February 2023 alongside a \$25 million funding raise, is positioned to become a crucial layer above existing data lake table formats—Apache Iceberg, Apache Hudi, and Databricks' Delta Lake. This layer allows seamless conversions and access across these formats, unlocking new possibilities for interoperability.

Microsoft's involvement is aligned with its data lake approach called Fabric, supporting the Delta Lake table format. Raghu Ramakrishnan, CTO for data at Microsoft, stressed the importance of enabling openness, stating, "We want a pathway where people can buy into our ecosystem without feeling blocked." This move is part of Microsoft's strategy to create a



single, open framework.

Gerrit Kazmaier, VP data and analytics at Google Cloud,

explained that organisations often struggle to choose a primary table format, leading to potential long-term consequences. OneTable, he noted, is not replacing different data lake table formats but alleviates the burden of choosing one that might result in lock-in.

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